De Beers Group Consulting Challenge

Ashoka University, Sonepat Haryana

Project Eternal

Team: Case Flayers

Positioning India as the World's Next Diamond Capital



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Overview of De Beers' India Opportunity

Rising Demand, Shifting Consumers, and the Lab-Grown Threat

Market Opportunity

T · A · M — Indian Gems & Jewellery

$85B → $120–140B by 2030
12–14% CAGR | Expanding across Tier 1–3 cities

S · A · M — Natural Diamond Jewellery

$10B → $17B by 2030
10-12% CAGR | Fastest-Growing Luxury Segment

S · O · M — Lab-Grown Threat to Address

$600–700M ~6% share
Price-driven | Growing fast | No emotional moat

The Indian Paradox

90%
of world's diamonds cut & polished in India

≠

<6%
share of global diamond consumption domestically

Indian hands shape every diamond. Indian consumers rarely choose them.

THE UNCOPYABLE MOAT

Time
1-3.3B years (natural) vs 6-10 weeks (lab-grown)
→ No technology can manufacture geological time
→ Only physical object older than civilization

DB
DE BEERS GROUP

Rising Incomes
Gold-to-luxury transition accelrating in urban India

Gen Z Buyers
Already a substantial share of new diamond purchasers

Middle Class Expansion
New buyer base emerging across Tier 2 & 3 cities

Occasion Shift
Self-purchase, gifting, milestones rising beyond weddings

Threat Trajectory

Without intervention:
- Lab-grown → 15-18% market share by 2030
- ₹9,000-11,000 Cr annual revenue loss
- Gen Z preference shift: 62% consider LGD "acceptable"

Stop defending rarity. Start selling irreplaceable TIME—the only moat lab-grown can never close.

Why India Is The Perfect Market

Reframing value in the age of lab-grown diamonds

Why Natural Diamonds Are Losing Relevance

Rarity Erosion

When identical, rarity loses value.



Lab-grown=identical at 1/10th price

Demand is Limited

Single-occasion driven demand.



Weddings = one purchase per lifetime

The Solution: Repositioning Natural Diamonds Around Time

Lab-Grown

6–10 Weeks

Manufactured
Reproducible
Forgettable

Manufactured Real

Natural

3.3 Billion Years

Formed
Enduring
Irreplaceable

Earned Real

No lab. No technology. No future innovation can ever close this gap.

Time is the only uncopyable advantage

WHY IT WORKS SPECIFICALLY IN INDIA

Cultural Legacy
Indians pass down meaning. Diamonds fit.

National Craft
90% of global cutting. Minimal domestic capture.

Gen Z Hunger
Authenticity fatigue is real. Imperfection signals truth.

WALK AWAY FROM

- Price-based competition
- Technical superiority claims
- Wedding-only messaging
- Naming lab-grown directly

Marketing and Brand Strategy

What's Your Diamond Story? A Cultural Infrastructure Investment

JOB 1: DEFEND

Protect existing emotional territory-weddings, legacy, family-from lab-grown erosion on price.

JOB 2: EXPAND

Move into self-purchase, career milestones, gifting before lab-grown fully colonises those occasions

JOB 3: RECRUIT

Convert Gen Z right now. Their luxury preferences are forming. This is the most underinvested job.

Brand Pillars

B
Born of Earth
Naturally formed over billions of years

O
One of One
Truly unique, non-replicable by any process

L
Lasting Legacy
Enduring value, emotion, and generational significance

D
Deeply Sourced
Responsibly mined, livelihood-driven.

Rare, authentic, timeless heirlooms-natural diamonds retain generational value over lab-grown.

Execution Architecture

3 TARGET SEGMENTS

- **Millennials (27–35)**: Self-buy, authenticity
- **Parents (40–55)**: Gifting, legacy
- **Gen Z (20–26)**: Discovery, authenticity

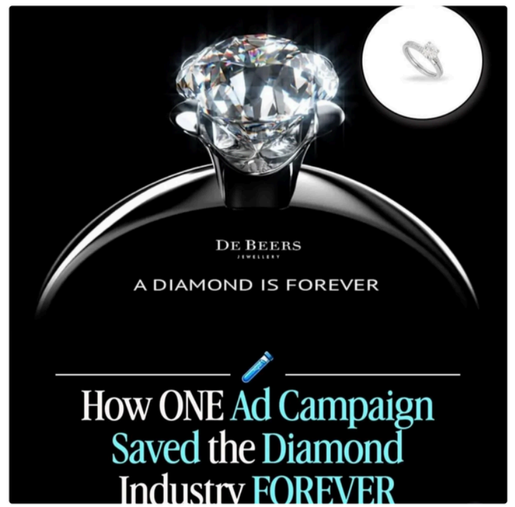
CHANNEL ARCHITECTURE

- **OTT/TV**: Legacy, family
- **Instagram/YouTube**: Self, stories
- **WhatsApp + INDRA**: Jewellers
- **Tanishq stores**: POS proof

NEW OCCASIONS TO OWN

- **Pehli Tanakaah**: Salary
- **Maa Ka Heera**: Mother–daughter
- **Naya Adhyaya**: Milestones
- **Target**: Weddings 35–50%

#WHAT'SYOURSTORY



Why will this work?
product → meaning
brand-driven messaging → consumer-driven storytelling.

Reclaiming the Story

Making Natural Diamonds the Next Gen Standard

Campaign Timeline and Implementaion

Month 1-3	Month 4	Month 5	Month 6	Month 6+
#what'syourstory 3-Phase Movement 20–30 real women, no celebs initially Story tags, zero ad spend 5-chapter story per diamond UGC Instagram Youtube	**Hands of Surat** Documentary Series 5 YouTube episodes, one artisan family each Craft, heritage, identity Sustainability: human-centric, not environmental Youtube Docuseries	**Meet Your Diamond First** GenZ Entry Point Scan any stone: full geological story 23-year-old scans mother's ring: it is a real surprise content Science-reveal format Gen Z shares naturally Instagram Provenance App	**Story Stations** Retail Reimagined 200 Tanishq stores: narration, not selling Diamond Storytellers in-store 5-chapter provenance card + blank 6th Tanishq INDRA Alliance	**Karan Aujla: The Indian Ambassador** Cultural Anchor Testimony, not sponsorship; his own diamond Canada · UK · UAE · Australia diaspora Global Indian reach, no separate strategy Diaspora Film
1	2	3	4	5
Three-phase movement making diamond stories a cultural norm.	A documentary that reframes ethics—by making human stories impossible to ignore.	A Gen Z–first app revealing the stories of inherited diamonds.	Retail as brand proof, not transaction point.	Not an endorsement. A confirmation.

Stop selling diamonds. Start selling the only thing no one can manufacture: irreplaceable time.

Behind the Campaigns

How all the campaigns work together

#what'syourstory

Creates a behaviour and makes it a social norm. Knowing your diamond's story separates ownership from true possession. Lab-grown has no story to enter this norm.

Meet Your Diamond First

Creates first discovery. A billion-year journey turns it from object to phenomenon-lab-grown has nothing

Story Stations

Creates a new buying ritual. The story is told before the price, turning purchase into participation. Lab-grown cannot compete where narrative defines value.

Sports

The Sport of Permanence : F1, Golf & Wimbledon

- F1 moments outperform yearlong campaigns among young audiences
- Golf attracts the highest concentration of high-net-worth global consumers
- Wimbledon dinner reaches 500M viewers, building unmatched premium brand equity

Hands of Surat

5 YouTube episodes. Each follows one artisan family in Surat—their craft, generational knowledge, and identity built around diamond cutting. It will be pure human story and not a brand message.

THE REFRAME

Gen Z's "lab-grown = ethical" is abstract; generational craft is real —once seen, everything shifts.

THE RESULT

Sustainability reframed, not debated—you show what can't be unseen.

Meet the Brand Ambassador: Karan Aujla



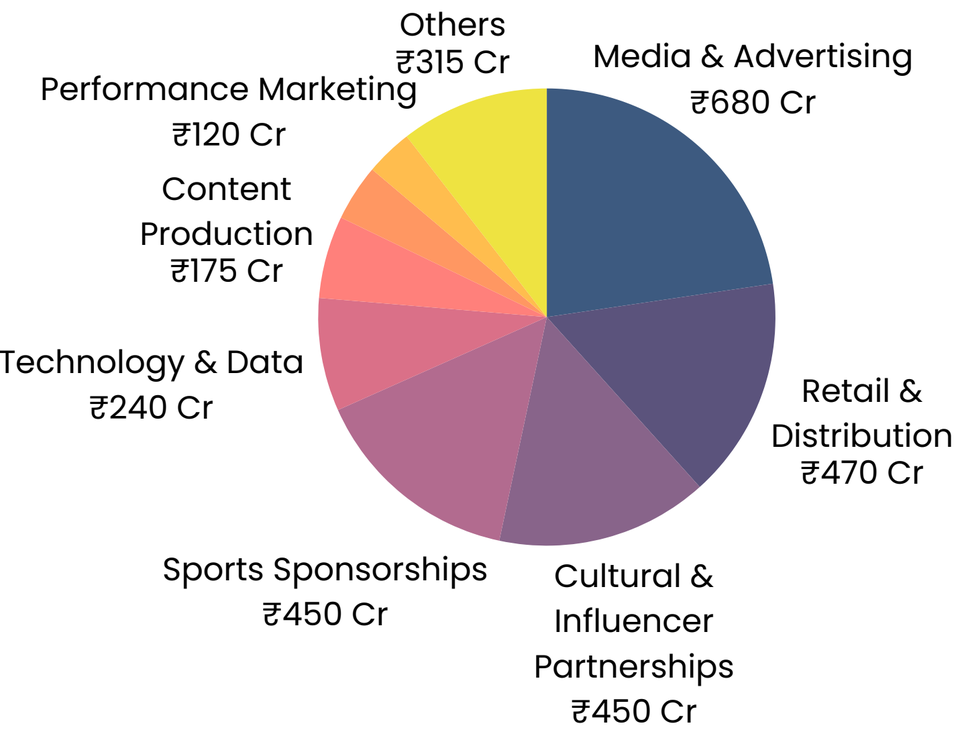
Why him?
His bond with natural diamonds predates the partnership-he authenticates, not advertises; his fanbase amplifies reach.

Diaspora
Canada · UK · UAE · Australia.
High-value Indian diaspora markets: one campaign, global Indian reach.

He came from nothing and built something permanent-exactly what a natural diamond represents. Not manufactured. Survived.

Investment Plan

₹3,250 Cr Over 3 Years | Phased Budget Allocation



BUDGET BREAKDOWN

₹3250 Cr | FY26 - FY29

Based on 10% category-building benchmark

Phase 1: Seed

₹300 Cr | Months 1–3

- Provenance App + Tech Backbone
- 500 INDRA Jewellers Trained
- WhatsApp Seeding + Story Content
- Tanishq Pilot (10 stores)

Phase 2 - Amplify

₹1,400 Cr | Months 4–8

- Celebrity + Cultural Figures
- Sports Sponsorships (F1, Tennis, Golf)
- OTT + TV Media (₹250 Cr)
- Tanishq Rollout (200 stores)
- Influencers + Festive Push

Phase 3 - Norm

₹1,300 Cr | Months 9–36

- Story Tag Viral Loop
- Tier 2/3 Influencer Scale
- New Occasion Campaigns
- Performance Marketing
- 2x Festive Cycles

Expected Impact

Consumer Behavior

- 5M Provenance Users
- 10,000 Organic Stories
- +25% Store Engagement
- 62% Non-Wedding Purchases

Business Impact

- ₹17,000 Cr Category Growth
- +8–12% Sales Uplift
- 5.7x ROMI
- 3x Defence Value

KPI

10,000+
Organic UGC Stories

₹17,000 Cr
Incremental Category Revenue

<12%
Lab-Grown Share Contained

The Journey Ahead

Strategic Roadmap: Defend, Expand, Recruit

Build the Infrastructure
Phase 1 | Months 1-6

Brand & Technology

- Tracr pilot across 500 Tanishq stores with provenance QR on purchases
- Provenance app soft-launched for early users
- Staff trained under Diamond Storyteller programme

Distribution

INDRA Alliance onboarded 500 Tier 2/3 jewellers, completed an 8-city baseline survey, and finalized campaign creatives ahead of the Month 5 launch.

Ignite the Narrative
Phase 2 | Months 7-18

Campaign Launches

- Months 7–10: the full campaign launch across digital/OTT/retail
- The Hands of Surat YouTube series
- The Karan Aujla film and provenance app launch
- Maa Ka Heera Mother's Day campaign activation.

Distribution Scale

- INDRA Alliance scaled to 1,500 jewellers - Story Kits deployed
- ₹25K–50K Milestone Collection launch
- Dhanteras/Diwali campaign push.

Scale & Defend
Phase 1 | Months 9-36

Scale

- Tracr expanded to 200 Diamond Expertise Centers
- INDRA scaled to 3,000 jewellers
- OOH extended to 15 Tier 2 cities
- Campaign refreshed with a new milestone

Defend

- Independent audit tracked milestone share shift
- lab-grown competition assessed
- Story Tag reached scale with organic impressions surpassing paid media.

$15B	35%	40%	3000	35%
Natural diamond market India by 2028	Self-purchase share (from 25% today)	Gen Z buyer share (from 25% today)	INDRA jewellers activated	Wedding-only share (down from 50%)

ANNEXURE

1. Indian Gems & Jewellery Market — IBEF Report 2024–25
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